

Golden snub-nosed monkey

Rhinopithecus roxellana

This Chinese monkey lives its entire life in a series of groups, the size of which waxes and wanes depending upon the season. During the warmer months, a single group's numbers can swell to 200 or even 600 individuals. In winter, this splits into several groups of 60–70 monkeys, which are further divided into small family troops of a single male, several females, and their offspring or all-male groups.

Startling appearance

With vertical nostrils and dark, almond-shaped eyes set in a striking blue face framed by blazing red-gold fur, golden snub-nosed monkeys look more like alien elves than primates. Yet for all their unique features, because they live in high mountainous forests and spend over 95 percent of their time in trees, snub-nosed monkeys are heard more than they are seen. Their calls are eerily humanlike, and frequently compared to the cries of young children or babies. Highly prized by hunters, their fur is so long across the back and shoulders that when they leap from one branch to another it gives the appearance of wings.

- ↔ 19–33 in (48–84 cm)
- ⚖ 13–42 lb (6–19 kg)
- ⊗ Endangered
- 🌿 Lichen, leaves, fruit, bark
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SE. Asia

▽ GROOMING SESSION

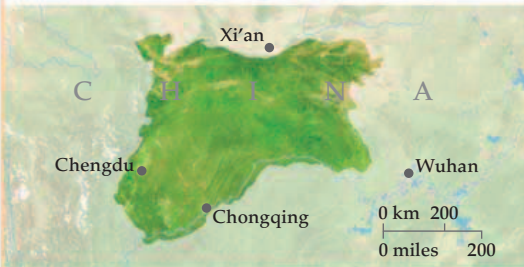
Golden snub-nosed monkeys regularly check each other for parasites, a practice usually accompanied by whining and squealing.



Snub-nosed monkeys can **vocalize without moving their faces** or bodies

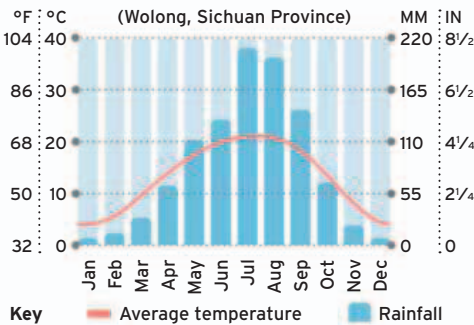
LOCATION

Cover 150,600 sq miles (390,000 sq km) in the provinces of Shaanxi and Sichuan in south-central China.



CLIMATE

The Upper Yangtze has a warm, temperate climate, with most rainfall occurring in the peak summer months.



FAST-GROWING GRASS
Among the world's fastest-growing plants, bamboo is a member of the grass family. More than 500 species grow in China alone. Bamboo is unusual in exhibiting mass flowering, where all plants in one stand flower together, set seed, and then die.

BAMBOO

of China's mammal species

